BEC
ELECTRICAL CONTRACTORS

CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

Budget Electrical Contractors Inc. | Chapter 4 of the Health and Safety Manual, issued as a standalone posting | v1.2, Effective October 1, 2026 | Revised October 15, 2026

This Code is posted at each job location and reviewed at orientation and in regular safety meetings. It states minimum requirements; the Health and Safety Manual and the pre-task plan govern the details of each task.

GENERAL SAFE PRACTICES

1. All work is performed under this Code, the Health and Safety Manual, and the pre-task plan (JHA) for the task. The plan names the heaviest or most repetitive manual handling, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates. When the work changes, the plan changes first.

2. Every employee has the authority and the duty to stop any work they believe is unsafe. No employee will be disciplined for a good-faith stop or report.

3. Report every injury, near miss, and instance of property, equipment, or utility damage to your supervisor before the end of the shift.

4. Report to work fit for duty: free of impairment from alcohol, drugs, medications that impair, and fatigue. Disclose impairing medications before the shift.

5. Required PPE is worn in all designated areas: hard hat, safety glasses, high-visibility apparel, safety-toe boots, and gloves suited to the task, plus task-specific PPE per the plan.

6. Horseplay, fighting, and pranks are prohibited on all work premises.

7. Keep work areas clean as the work proceeds: walkways clear, cords and hoses out of paths, nails removed or bent, materials stacked stable, spills cleaned or guarded immediately.

8. Inspect tools and equipment before use. Defective tools and equipment are tagged out of service and turned in, never used carefully.

9. Machine guards and safety devices stay in place and functional. Removing or defeating a guard is a serious violation.

10. Cord-connected tools operate on GFCI protection. Damaged cords are removed from service; grounding pins are never removed.

11. Ladders are inspected before use, set on firm level footing, and climbed with three points of contact facing the ladder. Consider a lift or scaffold before choosing a ladder.

12. Use mechanical means or a lifting aid first: forklift, dolly, cart, hoist, or the aid named in the plan. One person lifts no more than 50 pounds alone under good conditions; 50 to 100 pounds is a team lift or mechanical; over 100 pounds is mechanical, always. Keep loads close and turn with the feet, not the back. Rotate high-repetition and high-vibration tasks where the work allows. Report aches, pain, numbness, tingling, or loss of grip to your supervisor the same day; reporting is never disciplined.

13. Never dry-cut, dry-grind, or dry-sweep concrete, masonry, or asphalt. Use water or vacuum dust controls, always.

14. Wear hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment.

15. Follow the heat illness prevention program: drink water throughout the shift, use shade, take cool-down rests when needed, and watch coworkers for symptoms.

16. Know the emergency plan for your location: alarm, muster point, and who calls 911. Never move a seriously injured person except to prevent further injury, and never drive yourself for treatment of a serious injury.

17. Seatbelts are worn in every vehicle and every machine so equipped. Handheld phone use while operating is prohibited. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

18. Only trained and authorized employees operate equipment, machinery, or vehicles, or perform work requiring certification.

ELECTRICAL WORK

19. Work de-energized by default: locked and tagged with personal locks on every source, and tested dead with a meter verified live-dead-live.

20. Energized work is performed only under an energized work permit by qualified persons in PPE per the arc flash analysis.

21. No one removes another person's lock.

22. Wire pulls keep all personnel out of line with the rope, rigging, and capstan; reels are moved and staged with equipment.

23. Only fiberglass ladders are used; all cords operate on GFCI protection.

EXCAVATION AND UNDERGROUND UTILITIES

24. No mechanical excavation until utility marks are on the ground and the 811 ticket and client locates are current.

25. Within the tolerance zone of a marked utility, expose the line with hand tools or vacuum excavation only, until the line is positively visually verified.

26. Any unidentified line, or any line not shown on marks or plans, stops all excavation in the area until identified.

27. Any contact with a utility, including coating damage, is reported immediately. Damaged gas lines require immediate upwind evacuation and 911.

HEIGHTS, LIFTS, AND SCAFFOLDS

28. Fall protection at 6 feet. In boom lifts, wear a harness and lanyard attached to the manufacturer's anchor from the ground up, with feet on the platform floor.

29. Obey scaffold tags: green for use, yellow with restrictions, red or missing means do not use.

30. Choose a lift or scaffold over a ladder for extended or two-handed work.

HOT WORK

31. Hot work outside designated areas requires a hot work permit: combustibles cleared or protected within 35 feet, an extinguisher at the work, and a fire watch during the work and at least 30 minutes after.

32. Never perform hot work on containers that held flammables without a specific cleared procedure.

Stop work authority applies to every rule above. Questions, hazards, and anonymous reports: Corporate Safety, Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912.